

BL STUDY PACKET

Tonight - Bladder Meridian Only

WHAT'S INSIDE (in order):

1. Study Guide - BL section (pathway, crossing points, syndromes, high-yield)
2. Cram Sheet - BL card
3. Special Points Decoder - BL entries
4. Retrieval Drill - BL grid (Parts 1 & 2) + Back-Shu spinal-order drill
5. Retrieval Drill Answer Key - BL only

HOW TO USE THIS PACKET:

Read the Study Guide/Cram Sheet/Decoder BL sections once to reload context. Then go straight to the Retrieval Drill and write answers cold before checking the Answer Key at the back. KI is saved for tomorrow morning - don't start it tonight.

WEEK 5

Print Edition

Week 5 Study Guide

Bladder & Kidney Channels

BL (67 pts) + KI (27 pts) = 94 Points

This Week Covers:

- Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang (BL1-BL67) with MOA + CAM figures
- BL 5 Branches — full detailed running course (longest channel in the body)
- BL 14 Crossing Points — the most of any channel
- Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin (KI1-KI27) with MOA + CAM figures
- KI 3 Branches — full detailed running course, ending at the Pericardium link
- KI 6 Crossing Points — abdomen and chest
- Full Back-Shu Series (BL13-BL28) — organ transport points
- Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls — direct from lecture
- BL vs KI Quick Reference — side-by-side comparison

QUIZ 4 (next class) covers: BL & KI channels.

BL & KI are taught this week; PC & SJ will be TAUGHT next week (Week 6).

MOA: BL pp.251-256 | KI pp.331-335

CAM: Col. Fig. 8-9 | Slides: Dr. Vivian Zhang, Week 5

The Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang

Yang | Water | 3 PM – 5 PM | 67 Points

Pertaining Bladder

Connecting Kidney

Back-Shu BL28

Front-Mu CV3 Zhongji

Yuan-Source BL64

Luo BL58

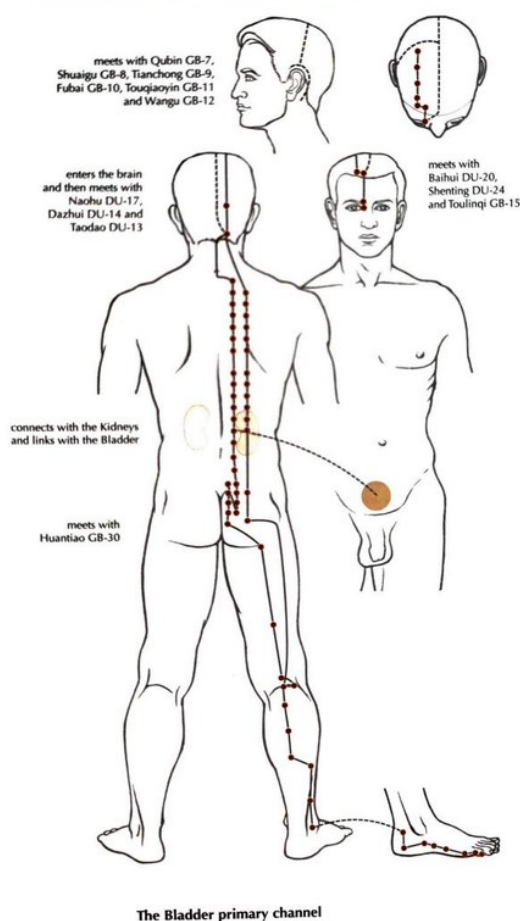
He-Sea BL40

Internal Running Course

Bladder Channel

251

THE BLADDER CHANNEL OF FOOT TAIYANG



The Bladder primary channel

MOA - BL Meridian (internal pathway)

- 1 Starts from the inner canthus (Jingming, BL1), ascends the forehead (BL2 Zanzhu, BL3 Meichong, BL4 Quchai) toward the vertex.
- 2 Continues up the forehead (BL5, BL6, BL7 Tongtian), joining the Governor Vessel at the vertex (Baihui, GV20).
- 3 BRANCH: from the vertex to the temple, crossing GB7, GB8, GB9, GB10, GB11 and GB12 — one of BL's 14 cross-points shared with the GV and GB channels.
- 4 STRAIGHT PORTION: from the vertex, enters and communicates with the brain, emerges and bifurcates at BL10 (Tianzhu) to descend the posterior neck.
- 5 Runs alongside the medial border of the scapula, parallel to the spine (BL11–BL17, alongside GV13/GV14), reaching the lumbar region (BL18–BL23).
- 6 Enters the body cavity, connects with the Kidney, and pertains to its home organ, the Bladder (BL24–BL30).
- 7 BRANCH: from the lumbar region, descends through the gluteal region and ends in the popliteal fossa (BL40 Weizhong).
- 8 BRANCH (largest): from the posterior neck, runs straight down the medial border of the scapula (BL41–BL54), through the gluteal region — meeting GB30 (Huantiao).
- 9 Descends the lateral thigh and meets the branch from Step 7 in the popliteal fossa (BL40), where the two lines merge into one.
- 10 Continues down the posterior leg (BL55, BL56, BL57) to the area behind the external malleolus (BL58, BL59, BL60).
- 11 Runs along the 5th metatarsal bone (BL61–BL64) to the lateral side of the tip of the little toe (BL65, BL66, BL67 Zhiyin).
- 12 LINKS with the Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin, continuing the Posterior Circuit.

Functions (MOA)

- Governs storage & excretion of urine (Water passageway)
- Longest channel; controls the posterior body surface
- Dominates tendons via the Bladder-Sinew channel
- ONLY channel carrying the full Back-Shu series (BL13–BL28)
- Front-Mu: CV3 Zhongji | Back-Shu: BL28 Pangguangshu

The Bladder Meridian (BL) - External Running Course & CAM Figures

Pertaining Bladder	Connecting Kidney	Back-Shu BL28	Front-Mu CV3 Zhongji	Yuan-Source BL64	Luo BL58	He-Sea BL40
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Pt	Chinese	Location & Notes
BL1	Jingming	0.1 cun superior to inner canthus
BL2	Zanzhu	Depression at medial end of eyebrow
BL3	Meichong	0.5 cun within hairline, above BL2
BL4	Quchai	0.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline
BL5	Wuchu	1 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline
BL6	Chengguang	2.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline
BL7	Tongtian	4 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline
BL8	Luoque	5.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline
BL9	Yuzhen	2.5 cun within hairline, 1.3 cun lateral to midline
BL10	Tianzhu	1.3 cun lateral to midline, within hairline
BL11	Dazhu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T1 spinous process - Influential pt - Bone
BL12	Fengmen	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process
BL13	Feishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process - Back-Shu - Lung
BL14	Jueyinshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process - Back-Shu - Pericardium
BL15	Xinshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process - Back-Shu - Heart
BL16	Dushu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process
BL17	Geshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process - Influential pt - Blood
BL18	Ganshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process - Back-Shu - Liver
BL19	Danshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process - Back-Shu - Gallbladder
BL20	Pishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process - Back-Shu - Spleen
BL21	Weishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process - Back-Shu - Stomach
BL22	Sanjiaoshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process - Back-Shu - San Jiao
BL23	Shenshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process - Back-Shu - Kidney
BL24	Qihai	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L3 spinous process
BL25	Dachangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L4 spinous process - Back-Shu - Large Int.
BL26	Guanyuanshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L5 spinous process
BL27	Xiaochangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S1 foramen - Back-Shu - Small Int.
BL28	Pangguangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen - Back-Shu - Bladder
BL29	Zhonglvshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen
BL30	Baihuanshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S4 foramen
BL31	Shangliao	1st posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group
BL32	Ciliao	2nd posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group
BL33	Zhongliao	3rd posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group
BL34	Xialiao	4th posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group
BL35	Huiyang	0.5 cun lateral to tip of coccyx
BL36	Chengfu	Midpoint of transverse gluteal fold
BL37	Yinmen	6 cun below BL36, on line to BL40
BL38	Fuxi	1 cun above BL39, medial to biceps femoris tendon
BL39	Weiyang	Lateral end of popliteal crease - Lower He-Sea of San Jiao
BL40	Weizhong	Midpoint of popliteal crease - He-Sea; Command - back
BL41	Fufen	3 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process
BL42	Pohu	3 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process
BL43	Gaohuang	3 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process - All deficiency-taxation
BL44	Shentang	3 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process
BL45	Yixi	3 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process
BL46	Geguan	3 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process
BL47	Hunmen	3 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process
BL48	Yanggang	3 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process
BL49	Yishe	3 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process
BL50	Weicang	3 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process
BL51	Huangmen	3 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process
BL52	Zhishi	3 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process
BL53	Baohuang	3 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen
BL54	Zhibian	3 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen
BL55	Heyang	2 cun below BL40, on line to BL57
BL56	Chengjin	5 cun below BL40, top of gastrocnemius
BL57	Chengshan	8 cun below BL40, apex of gastrocnemius - Classic for hemorrhoids
BL58	Feiyang	7 cun above BL60, postero-inferior to gastrocnemius - Luo-connecting
BL59	Fuyang	3 cun directly above BL60 - Xi-Cleft of Yang Qiao Mai
BL60	Kunlun	Depression between lat. malleolus & Achilles tendon - Jing-River
BL61	Pucan	Below BL60, 4 cun inferior to lateral malleolus
BL62	Shenmai	Depression directly below lateral malleolus - Confluent - Yang Qiao Mai
BL63	Jinmen	Anterior-inferior to BL62, lateral foot - Xi-Cleft
BL64	Jinggu	Lateral foot, antero-inferior to 5th MT tuberosity - Yuan-Source
BL65	Shugu	Posterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint - Shu-Stream
BL66	Zutonggu	Anterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint - Ying-Spring
BL67	Zhiyin	Lateral side of tip of small toe - Jing-Well; last point

CAM Col. Fig. 8 - Bladder Meridian

BL – Crossing Points (Detailed)

Dr. Zhang: "BL has 14 crossing points – the most of any single channel. Most are located around the head. Any headache/eye/neck symptom – always consider BL channel too."

GV24 Shenting + GB15 Toulinqi

GV24 / GB15

Location: Forehead / anterior hairline

Clinical:

BL's first branch (BL2–BL4) crosses the Governor Vessel and Gallbladder channel here as it ascends the forehead toward the vertex. Used for frontal headache, dizziness, nasal congestion.

GB7–GB12 (six-point temple group)

GB channel

Location: Temple region, ear to mastoid

Clinical:

BL's temple branch (Step 3) crosses all six of these Gallbladder points — Qubin, Shuaigu, Tianchong, Fubai, Touqiaoyin, Wangu. Migraine, temporal headache, tinnitus, TMJ-region pain.

GV20 Baihui

GV20 / Du Mai

Location: Vertex, midline

Clinical:

BL joins the Governor Vessel at the very top of the head. Classic point for headache, dizziness, prolapse (organ/rectal/uterine), and calming the shen.

GV16 Fengfu + GV17 Naohu

GV16–17 / Du Mai

Location: Nape / occiput, brain region

Clinical:

BL's straight portion communicates with the brain and crosses these two Du Mai points before bifurcating at BL10. Occipital headache, stiff neck, dizziness.

GV13 Taodao + GV14 Dazhui

GV13–14 / Du Mai

Location: Upper back, alongside BL11–BL17

Clinical:

BL's back line runs parallel to the spine alongside these Governor Vessel points. Dazhui (GV14) is the meeting point of all Yang channels — fever, neck stiffness, immune support.

GB30 Huantiao

GB30 / GB channel

Location: Gluteal region

Clinical:

BL's largest branch passes directly through this Gallbladder point in the buttock on its way down the posterior thigh. Classic point for sciatica and hip/low-back pain along the pathway.

BL – Syndromes & High-Yield Points

A. External Course Symptoms

- Headache (two head branches cross the brain region)
- Stiff neck, rigidity of the spine
- Low back pain, lumbar pain along the running course
- Sciatica-type pain, calf pain, stiff/painful leg
- Eye disorders (redness, pain, blurred vision — near BL1)
- Occipital pain, pain of the scapula and back

B. Internal Organ (Bladder)

- Difficult or painful urination, retention of urine
- Enuresis, dark or turbid urine
- Bladder-qi dysfunction generally
- Via Back-Shu series: dysfunction of ANY zang-fu organ
- (Dr. Zhang: acupuncture is especially effective for urinary retention)

BL13-BL28 = Back-Shu series | treats ANY zang-fu organ directly from the back
 Dr. Zhang: "Acupuncture is really good for the urination... just one point can treat it."

High-Yield Points

Pt	Chinese	Category	Key Indications
BL2	Zanzhu	Local eye point	Eye redness/pain, frontal headache, wind dizziness
BL10	Tianzhu	Neck region	Dizziness, occipital pain, neck rigidity, heavy head
BL13	Feishu	Back-Shu of Lung	Cough, asthma, chest fullness — treats Lung from the back
BL23	Shenshu	Back-Shu of Kidney	Low back pain, Kidney-deficiency patterns, tinnitus
BL25	Dachangshu	Back-Shu of Large Intestine	Diarrhea, constipation, low back pain
BL28	Pangguangshu	Back-Shu of Bladder	Difficult urination, retention, enuresis
BL40	Weizhong	He-Sea + Command (back)	Low back pain, stiffness of the spine; clears summer-heat
BL57	Chengshan	Calf belly	Classic point for hemorrhoids; calf cramp/spasm
BL60	Kunlun	Jing-River	"Aspirin of acupuncture" — headache, pain anywhere on pathway
BL62	Shenmai	Confluent — Yang Qiao Mai	Insomnia (daytime type), epilepsy, lower-limb disorders
BL67	Zhiyin	Jing-Well; last point	Corrects fetal malposition with moxa; labor induction

Five-Shu (Antique) Points - BL | Yang channel: Jing-Well = Metal

Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Metal	BL67 Zhiyin	Loss of consciousness, epilepsy, mania; last-point resuscitation
Ying-Spring	Water	BL66 Zutonggu	Headache, neck pain, epistaxis
Shu-Stream	Wood	BL65 Shugu	Headache, neck rigidity, mania
Jing-River	Fire	BL60 Kunlun	Headache/pain anywhere; difficult labor; "aspirin" point
He-Sea	Earth	BL40 Weizhong	Low back pain, command point for the back; clears summer-heat

The Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang

Yang | Water | 3 PM – 5 PM | 67 pts

PATHWAY — 5 branches

1st: BL1 Jingming · Last: BL67 Zhiyin

1. Inner canthus -> vertex
2. vertex -> temple
3. vertex -> bladder
4. lumbar region -> popliteal fossa
5. posterior neck -> little toe

SPECIAL POINTS

- Jing-Well: BL67 Zhiyin
- Ying-Spring: BL66 Zutonggu
- Shu-Stream: BL65 Shugu
- Jing-River: BL60 Kunlun
- He-Sea: BL40 Weizhong
- Yuan-Source: BL64 Jinggu
- Luo-Connecting: BL58 Feiyang
- Xi-Cleft: BL63 Jinmen
- Front-Mu (of Bladder): CV3 Zhongji
- Back-Shu (of Bladder): BL28 Pangguangshu
- Command Point (back): BL40 Weizhong

BACK-SHU SERIES (BL13–BL28)

Organ transport points — treats every zang-fu organ directly

- BL13 — Lung
- BL14 — Pericardium
- BL15 — Heart
- BL18 — Liver
- BL19 — Gallbladder
- BL20 — Spleen
- BL21 — Stomach
- BL22 — San Jiao
- BL23 — Kidney
- BL25 — Large Intestine
- BL27 — Small Intestine
- BL28 — Bladder

FUNCTION LOGIC

- Running-course function: Two branches cross the head/brain -> headache. Two long parallel lines run the entire back -> low back pain, calf pain, stiff leg, sciatica-type pain along the pathway.
- Internal-organ function: Pertains to the Bladder -> urination disorders. Dr. Zhang notes acupuncture is particularly effective for urinary retention — cites a clinical case where a single point resolved the presentation.
- Back-Shu bridge function: BL13–BL28 are the Back-Shu (transport) points for all twelve zang-fu organs, so BL is also the channel you reach for to treat any other organ system via its associated Back-Shu point (e.g., BL13 Lung, BL15 Heart, BL18 Liver, BL20 Spleen, BL21 Stomach, BL23 Kidney, BL25 Large Intestine, BL27 Small Intestine, BL28 Bladder).

TRAP NOTES

! TRAP: BL does NOT connect to the Lung. Do not confuse with LU or the Metal-element pathway — BL's internal connection is Kidney only (confirmed midterm-era trap note).

! The two parallel lines on the back (1.5 cun and 3 cun lateral to the spine) run SIMULTANEOUSLY, not as a sequential loop. Dr. Zhang confirmed in Q&A: a student asked whether the back line travels down, back up, and down again, or runs both lines at the same time — answer: "at the same time." Do not draw it as one line doubling back.

! BL has 14 cross-points total, shared with two other channels: the Governor Vessel (GV) and the Gallbladder (GB) channel, concentrated around the head. You are not expected to know each of the 14 individually — only that BL shares crossing points with GV and GB.

! BL7 (Tongtian) is NOT the vertex-joining point — that is GV20 (Baihui), which BL merely joins at the vertex.

CLINICAL PEARLS

- BL40 (Weizhong): He-Sea, Command point for the back; clears summer-heat; low back pain.
- Back-Shu points (BL13–BL28): organ transport points — treat the corresponding zang-fu organ directly from the back.
- BL60 (Kunlun): called the "aspirin of acupuncture" — headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor.
- BL67 (Zhiyin): corrects fetal malposition with moxibustion; used for labor induction.
- BL62 (Shenmai) and BL63 (Jinmen) sit close together on the lateral foot below the malleolus — BL62 is the Confluent point (opens Yang Qiao Mai); BL63 is the Xi-Cleft.

COMMONLY CONFUSED

- BL40 vs BL54 vs BL57: All are leg/thigh points on the same posterior line: BL40 Weizhong (popliteal crease, He-Sea/Command) -> BL54 Zhibian (upper thigh/sacrum) -> BL57 Chengshan (calf belly, 8 cun below BL40). Sequence matters for the running-course quiz format.

The Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang — Special Points Decoded

Category	Point	WHY this point, specifically
Jing-Well	BL67 Zhiyin	Corrects fetal malposition with moxa; labor induction
Ying-Spring	BL66 Zutonggu	See point-reference table in Study Guide for full indications.
Shu-Stream	BL65 Shugu	See point-reference table in Study Guide for full indications.
Jing-River	BL60 Kunlun	“Aspirin of acupuncture” — headache, pain anywhere on pathway
He-Sea	BL40 Weizhong	Low back pain, stiffness of the spine; clears summer-heat
Yuan-Source	BL64 Jinggu	See point-reference table in Study Guide for full indications.
Luo-Connecting	BL58 Feiyang	See point-reference table in Study Guide for full indications.
Xi-Cleft	BL63 Jinmen	See point-reference table in Study Guide for full indications.
Front-Mu (of Bladder)	CV3 Zhongji	See point-reference table in Study Guide for full indications.
Back-Shu (of Bladder)	BL28 Pangguangshu	Difficult urination, retention, enuresis
Command Point (back)	BL40 Weizhong	Low back pain, stiffness of the spine; clears summer-heat

Five-Transport Element Logic

BL is a Yang channel, so its Five-Transport sequence starts at Metal (Jing-Well) and cycles through the five elements toward its He-Sea point. Remember: Yin channels start at Wood; Yang channels start at Metal — this is why Yuan-Source always equals Shu-Stream on Yin channels but never on Yang channels (Yang channels have a SEPARATE, later Yuan-Source point).

Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Metal	BL67 Zhiyin	Loss of consciousness, epilepsy, mania; last-point resuscitation
Ying-Spring	Water	BL66 Zutonggu	Headache, neck pain, epistaxis
Shu-Stream	Wood	BL65 Shugu	Headache, neck rigidity, mania
Jing-River	Fire	BL60 Kunlun	Headache/pain anywhere; difficult labor; “aspirin” point
He-Sea	Earth	BL40 Weizhong	Low back pain, command point for the back; clears summer-heat

BL RETRIEVAL DRILL - PART 1

Week 5

Points BL1-BL34 - write the point name from the code, cold

Print Edition

BLADDER MERIDIAN OF FOOT-TAIYANG - BL1 to BL34

no peeking - answers on p.7

BL1		BL18	
BL2		BL19	
BL3		BL20	
BL4		BL21	
BL5		BL22	
BL6		BL23	
BL7		BL24	
BL8		BL25	
BL9		BL26	
BL10		BL27	
BL11		BL28	
BL12		BL29	
BL13		BL30	
BL14		BL31	
BL15		BL32	
BL16		BL33	
BL17		BL34	

PATHWAY SELF-TEST - INTERNAL RUNNING COURSE FIRST

1. BL originates near which facial feature? (write cold, then check MOA figure)

2. Direction of Qi flow in BL - Head -> Foot, or Foot -> Head?

3. BL is paired (interior/exterior) with which Yin channel?

4. How many lines does BL run down the back? (this defines the Back-Shu column layout)

BL RETRIEVAL DRILL - PART 2

Week 5

Points BL35-BL67 - Back-Shu column is your highest-yield cluster

Print Edition

BLADDER MERIDIAN - BL35 to BL67		gold dot = flagged high-yield	
BL35	_____	BL52	_____
BL36	_____	BL53	_____
BL37	_____	BL54	_____
BL38	_____	BL55	_____
BL39	_____	BL56	_____
BL40	_____	BL57	_____
BL41	_____	BL58	_____
BL42	_____	BL59	_____
BL43	_____	BL60	_____
BL44	_____	BL61	_____
BL45	_____	BL62	_____
BL46	_____	BL63	_____
BL47	_____	BL64	_____
BL48	_____	BL65	_____
BL49	_____	BL66	_____
BL50	_____	BL67	_____
BL51	_____		

BACK-SHU COLUMN - SPINAL ORDER, COLD	BL13->BL28, all 16
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Write the organ each Back-Shu point corresponds to, top to bottom, without checking:

BL13	_____	BL21	_____
BL14	_____	BL22	_____
BL15	_____	BL23	_____
BL16	_____	BL24	_____
BL17	_____	BL25	_____
BL18	_____	BL26	_____
BL19	_____	BL27	_____
BL20	_____	BL28	_____

ANSWER KEY - PART 1

Week 5

BL retrieval grid answers

Print Edition

BLADDER - ALL 67 ANSWERS

BL1	Jingming	BL35	Huiyang
BL2	Zanzhu	BL36	Chengfu
BL3	Meichong	BL37	Yinmen
BL4	Quchai	BL38	Fuxi
BL5	Wuchu	BL39	Weiyang
BL6	Chengguang	BL40	Weizhong
BL7	Tongtian	BL41	Fufen
BL8	Luoque	BL42	Pohu
BL9	Yuzhen	BL43	Gaohuang
BL10	Tianzhu	BL44	Shentang
BL11	Dashu	BL45	Yixi
BL12	Fengmen	BL46	Geguan
BL13	Feishu	BL47	Hunmen
BL14	Jueyinshu	BL48	Yanggang
BL15	Xinshu	BL49	Yishe
BL16	Dushu	BL50	Weicang
BL17	Geshu	BL51	Huangmen
BL18	Ganshu	BL52	Zhishi
BL19	Danshu	BL53	Baohuang
BL20	Pishu	BL54	Zhibian
BL21	Weishu	BL55	Heyang
BL22	Sanjiaoshu	BL56	Chengjin
BL23	Shenshu	BL57	Chengshan
BL24	Qihaishu	BL58	Feiyang
BL25	Dachangshu	BL59	Fuyang
BL26	Guanyuanshu	BL60	Kunlun
BL27	Xiaochangshu	BL61	Pucan
BL28	Pangguangshu	BL62	Shenmai
BL29	Zhonglushu	BL63	Jinmen
BL30	Baihuanshu	BL64	Jinggu
BL31	Shangliao	BL65	Shugu
BL32	Ciliao	BL66	Zutonggu
BL33	Zhongliao	BL67	Zhiyin
BL34	Xialiao		